

CASHIFY'S REFURBISHED REVOLUTION

AS INDIA'S REFURBISHED GADGET MARKET MATURES, CASHIFY'S NAKUL KUMAR EXPLORES THE INDUSTRY'S GROWTH DRIVERS, CHALLENGES, AND THE EVOLVING CONSUMER MINDSET SHAPING THIS RE-COMMERCE SECTOR

Jayesh Shinde | jayesh@digit.in



NAKUL KUMAR

Co-founder & CMO,
Cashify

Q How has the refurbished gadgets market evolved in India in the past few years? What are the key factors driving this growth?

A The refurbished market has always been predominated by unorganised players like local stores and websites where you can buy and sell things. They had introduced people to the value that pre-owned phones hold. The only gaps that the unorganised market had were a lack of warranties, refunds, or replacements. We, as organised players, are adding more structure to the market. We are helping bridge the gaps by improving the quality of gadgets and providing warranty, financing options and after-sale support. As a result, the trust in the segment is growing, further boosting the market. The segment has noticed a consistent growth of over 10% yearly since the pandemic. Increasing environmental consciousness is another factor encouraging people to make eco-friendly choices. As more and more upgrade to smartphones, the trend line will keep going up.

Q How does the refurbished gadgets market in India compare

to other major markets like the US or Europe?

A Driven by a large, price-sensitive consumer base, focusing on affordability, it is safe to say that India is a bigger market for refurbished goods than the western counterparts.

However, the market in India is less mature than that of the US and Europe. Consumer behaviour is largely different, with the US and Europe having a longer history of acceptance and education regarding refurbished products. The presence of strong policies and laws empowers the organised market, ensuring high quality and consumer protection. In contrast, India is yet to intensify its focus on these aspects.

On the other hand, much like the Western markets, India is also noticing a growth in consumer awareness and acceptance of refurbished products, driven by environmental concerns and the appeal of cost-effectiveness. Enhanced refurbishment processes and warranties are also playing a major role in improving the consumer trust globally.

Q What is Cashify's role in building trust and transparency in the

refurbished gadgets market? How do you ensure quality and authenticity of refurbished devices?

A Honestly, the refurbished world is clouded with doubts. As leaders of the organised market, it is our responsibility to structure our refurbishment process in a way that aids in building trust for refurbished gadgets. To ensure that only top-quality products leave our warehouse, we have a lineup of processes in place.

First is, every gadget is put through a rigorous 32-point quality check. Only the gadgets that pass this stringent inspection are certified as refurbished. To provide further clarity to the end-user, we grade devices as Superb, Good or Fair, based on their condition.

Data security is another top priority. We have tools that help us ensure that all phone data is irretrievably erased before resale.

Partnerships with reputable brands and retailers ensure a steady supply of high-quality gadgets for refurbishment